



Let's jump into the world of an extraordinary critter, the camel cricket! These amazing insects get their name from their humpbacked appearance, similar to a camel. They have long, spider-like legs and bodies that can grow up to 1.5 inches long. Their color ranges from light to dark brown, allowing them to blend in with their surroundings.



From their unique looks, we hop to their fascinating homes and diets. Camel crickets are found all over the world, especially in cool, damp places like caves, under stones, and in human basements. They are omnivorous scavengers, which means they'll munch on just about anything, from fungi, plant materials, to even other insects. Sometimes, they even eat each other when food is scarce!

Now that we've explored their homes and diets, let's leap into their life cycle and interactions. Camel crickets go through three stages: egg, nymph, and adult. They usually keep to themselves but can be a nuisance to humans when they invade homes, though they do not pose any serious threats. In the wild, they serve as a food source for other animals and help in breaking down decaying plant material.



From their role in the ecosystem, let's bounce to some unique facts and differences. Unlike their cricket cousins, camel crickets do not chirp because they don't have wings. Their 'humpback' design and long legs differentiate them from other cricket species and help them jump high when they are threatened. So, next time you spot a silent, jumping critter in your basement, remember it might just be a harmless camel cricket playing its part in the circle of life.



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What is the color of camel crickets?
 - A. They are colorful with vibrant red and yellow patterns.
 - B. They are black and white, like a zebra.
 - C. They are transparent and can blend with any color.
 - D. Their color ranges from light to dark brown.
- 2) What do camel crickets get their name from?
 - A. Because they spit like a camel does
 - B. They tend to hang around camels
 - C. Their ability to go a long time without water
 - D. Their humpbacked appearance
- 3) What happens when food is scarce for camel crickets?
 - A. They migrate to find new food sources.
 - B. They hibernate until food is available again.
 - C. They may eat other camel crickets.
 - D. They grow smaller and require less food.
- 4) What do camel crickets do when they are threatened?
 - A. They play dead when threatened.
 - B. They make a loud noise to scare off predators.
 - C. They jump high when they are threatened.
 - D. They release a foul-smelling odor to deter predators.
- 5) How does a camel crickets chirp compare to other crickets chirp?
 - A. Camel crickets do not chirp.
 - B. Camel crickets produce a low buzzing sound instead of chirping.
 - C. Camel crickets chirps are much louder.
 - D. Camel crickets chirps are much quieter.
- 6) Where can we commonly find camel crickets?
 - A. They are found in hot, dry desert environments.
 - B. They live in tall trees within dense rainforests.
 - C. They are found in cool, damp places.
 - D. They are commonly found in vast, open grassland.



- 7) What do camel crickets eat?
- A. They feed exclusively on blood of larger animals.
 - B. They eat just about anything, from fungi to other insects.
 - C. They prey solely on other insects and small animals.
 - D. They feed only on nectar and pollen from flowers.
- 8) Which is not a stage camel crickets go through in their life cycle?
- A. Nymph
 - B. Egg
 - C. Pupa
 - D. Adult
- 9) What is the size of a fully grown camel cricket?
- A. About an inch and a half
 - B. About the size of an apple seed
 - C. They are microscopic
 - D. They are half a foot long
- 10) Do camel crickets pose a serious threat to humans?
- A. No, they do not pose any serious threats to humans.
 - B. They have a poisonous bite that can harm humans.
 - C. Yes, they can be harmful to humans.
 - D. They can spread dangerous diseases to humans rapidly.

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "I am only found in tropical areas."
- 12) "I love chirping all night long."
- 13) "I'm not just an American cricket. You can find me all over the world."
- 14) "I just love the scorching heat of the desert."
- 15) "I prefer living in hot, dry places."
- 16) "Yuck, I would never eat other insects!"
- 17) "I love munching on plant materials and fungi."
- 18) "When you're as small as me, you have to eat almost anything and everything you find."
- 19) "I can easily hide from predators with my brown body that blends in with nature."
- 20) "I only eat plant materials, I never eat insects."
- 21) "We camel crickets have beautiful wings!"
- 22) "I go through only two stages: egg, and adult."
- 23) "I'm actually pretty important. I help to break down decaying plants."
- 24) "I can grow up to 3 inches long."
- 25) "While my cricket cousins sing, I don't have wings so you won't hear me at night."
- 26) "Sometimes, when food is scarce, I might even nibble on another camel cricket."
- 27) "I really like cool, damp places so that's where you're most likely to run across me."
- 28) "I only eat fresh food, never scavenged."
- 29) "I am bigger than you think! I can even grow up to an inch and half long."
- 30) "From a tiny egg to a big cricket, we go through three stages, laying eggs and then growing up!"

Determine if the statement is a fact or opinion based on the information in the article.

- 31) Camel crickets are omnivorous and eat a variety of things, including plant materials and other insects.





-
- 57) It's interesting to note that Camel crickets are not actually true crickets!
 - 58) Camel crickets are generally harmless and do not bite humans.
 - 59) How do camel crickets get their name?
 - 60) What do camel crickets eat?
 - 61) It's disgusting that camel crickets may eat each other if food is scarce!
 - 62) Camel crickets prefer dark and humid environments like basements and crawl spaces.
 - 63) What are some predators of camel crickets?
 - 64) Camel crickets can survive without food for weeks, that's amazing endurance!



Camel Crickets

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 56. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | 57. _____ |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | 58. _____ |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | 59. _____ |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | 60. _____ |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | 61. _____ |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | 62. _____ |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | 63. _____ |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | 64. _____ |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



Let's jump into the world of an extraordinary critter, the camel cricket! These amazing insects get their name from their humpbacked appearance, similar to a camel. They have long, spider-like legs and bodies that can grow up to 1.5 inches long. Their color ranges from light to dark brown, allowing them to blend in with their surroundings.



From their unique looks, we hop to their fascinating homes and diets. Camel crickets are found all over the world, especially in cool, damp places like caves, under stones, and in human basements. They are omnivorous scavengers, which means they'll munch on just about anything, from fungi, plant materials, to even other insects. Sometimes, they even eat each other when food is scarce!

Now that we've explored their homes and diets, let's leap into their life cycle and interactions. Camel crickets go through three stages: egg, nymph, and adult. They usually keep to themselves but can be a nuisance to humans when they invade homes, though they do not pose any serious threats. In the wild, they serve as a food source for other animals and help in breaking down decaying plant material.



From their role in the ecosystem, let's bounce to some unique facts and differences. Unlike their cricket cousins, camel crickets do not chirp because they don't have wings. Their 'humpback' design and long legs differentiate them from other cricket species and help them jump high when they are threatened. So, next time you spot a silent, jumping critter in your basement, remember it might just be a harmless camel cricket playing its part in the circle of life.



Camel Crickets

Name: _____

1.	D	26.	Would	51.	B
2.	D	27.	Would	52.	A
3.	C	28.	Not	53.	D
4.	C	29.	Would	54.	A
5.	A	30.	Would	55.	C
6.	C	31.	fact	56.	declarative
7.	B	32.	opinion	57.	exclamatory
8.	C	33.	fact	58.	declarative
9.	A	34.	opinion	59.	interrogative
10.	A	35.	fact	60.	interrogative
11.	Not	36.	opinion	61.	exclamatory
12.	Not	37.	fact	62.	declarative
13.	Would	38.	fact	63.	interrogative
14.	Not	39.	opinion	64.	exclamatory
15.	Not	40.	opinion		
16.	Not	41.	true		
17.	Would	42.	false		
18.	Would	43.	true		
19.	Would	44.	false		
20.	Not	45.	true		
21.	Not	46.	false		
22.	Not	47.	false		
23.	Would	48.	false		
24.	Not	49.	true		
25.	Would	50.	true		